



Water Economic Zone project by the DS Group, and other interventions have been recognised and honoured with the National Water Award, 2020 & FICCI Award (Category- Environmental Sustainability). 'Water Economic Zone' project alone has benefitted 23000 tribal people in Alsigarh and Kurabad situated in Udaipur district. The project has significantly improved the water table, introduced efficient irrigation techniques, and used solar energy in agriculture. This also potentially brought around 11000 hectares of land under double cropping. All these measures have led to an improved and sustainable economy for the local tribal communities.

A Leading Symbol of Green: The World's No.1 Green Building

The DS Headquarters, housing the corporate office, an R & D center with state of art manufacturing facilities has been awarded Leadership in Energy and Environmental Design (LEED) Platinum certification, under the USGBC (US Green Building Council) existing building O&M (Operation and Maintenance) program version 4.0 making it a global leader amongst all LEED v4 O&M existing buildings worldwide. Holding the highest number of credits amongst existing green buildings, the Group remains at the forefront for three consecutive years. The building also has a vision to get a carbon neutral status in next few years.

Majority of the total work force at the DSHQ uses alternate transport. This results in approximately 4,50,000 ton less CO_2 emissions, which is equivalent to planting 21,600 trees per year. An area of 26% is devoted to native vegetation. The building has nine rain water harvesting pits, and open grid pavers to reduce the storm water run-off from the site and enhance water quantity. The DSHQ also has an organic waste composter making it a close loop system of zero organic waste. Indoor water consumption has been reduced by 32%. Outdoor water usage has significantly reduced by using state of the art systems and technology for irrigation, sewage and effluent treatment. More than 50% of the regularly occupied area at DSHQ has daylight view, reducing artificial lighting consumption. The DSHQ's EPA (Environmental Protection Agency) energy star score is 95.

Towards Green Energy

Even though their processes are not energy intensive, DS Group has taken numerous initiatives towards Green Energy in line with the National Goal of reaching Net Zero Emission for environment protection and combating climate change.

The Group promotes the optimization and reduction of energy through well-defined processes and building a culture of commitment across the organization. Modern technologies have been implemented in various processes to reduce energy consumption, as well as to encourage use of renewable energy at the plants and corporate offices wherever possible. The energy consumption is monitored regularly to achieve continual improvement.

The Group is aggressively moving forward in captive power generation. Roof-top **Solar Power Plants** with cutting edge solar technology and a capacity of 2.94 MW have been installed at various locations of the organization. They have also entered into **Solar Open Access** agreements to obtain Green Energy of approximately 7.49 MW capacity. By these green energy initiatives, approximately 130.31 Lakhs kwh grid energy is saved and about 10,297 ton of CO_2 emission is reduced.

The DSHQ meets 80-82 % energy demand with the help of green power (In-house rooftop solar + open access solar).

Agro Forestry

To plant trees is to give body and life to one's dreams of a better world ~ Russel Page

In keeping with its vision of safeguarding environmental resources even while responding to in-house requirements, the DS Group entered the Agri Business with a focus on large-scale plantation by acquiring waste and semi-arid land parcels in different parts of the country and converted them to lush green forests for plantation purposes.

The DS Group is well known for its R&D excellence, and here too, the in-house R&D facility focuses on improving variety selection, planting material, package of practice, soil and nutrient management. Water conservation is ensured through 100% drip irrigation and with bio mulch (to conserve surface moisture), sub-surface tanks and ponds. Specially developed water storage structures in the barren lands have not only ensured self- sufficiency in water throughout the year, but also contributed to groundwater replenishment, and an ideal environment for the growth of local bio-diversity.

The environmental impact has been transformative. Besides the resultant biodiversity of flora and fauna, the afforestation has led to soil conservation, a reduction of soil erosion, more oxygen, and natural reduction in the weather temperature. Apart from the environmental impact, improvement of local infrastructure - road connectivity, electricity, education & local business has also taken place. Empowerment through employment to local men and women has led to improvement in socio economic conditions and reduction of rural outmigration.

The commitment and actions of this organization in building a better world for present and future generations are singularly outstanding. Their contribution is noteworthy and they lead the way for others to follow in our quest for a healthy world.